TraceForge

TLP:AMBER

Incident Reconstruction & IOC Correlation Report

Case: Sample incident

Analyst: Sample Analyst

Report ID: TF-20261105-7C271422 | Generated: 2026-11-05 10:25 UTC

Report ID	TF-20261105-7C271422	**Status**	**DRAFT**
Case	Sample incident	**Classification**	TLP:AMBER
Prepared by	Sample Analyst	**Generated**	2026-11-05 10:25 UTC
Tool	TraceForge v1.2.0	**Evidence**	4 file(s); SHA-256 listed in section 2
Redaction	None applied		

DRAFT - not reviewed. 4 of 4 incident(s) have no analyst verdict (INC-001, INC-002, INC-003, INC-004).

Handling (TLP:AMBER). Limited disclosure. Recipients may share only within their organisation and with clients who need to know.

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1. Executive summary

Highest severity	CRITICAL	**Incidents / findings**	4 / 17
Events analysed	555 from 4 source(s)	**ATT&CK tactics observed**	6
Evidence period	2026-03-13 07:00 to 2026-03-14 03:14 UTC	**IOCs recorded**	1

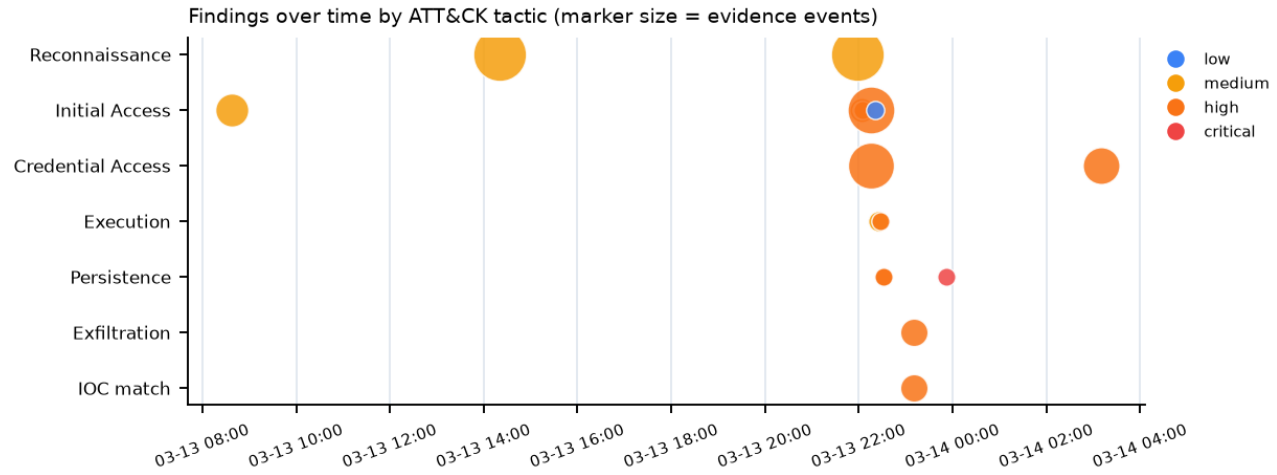
Highest priority is **INC-001** - Multi-stage activity involving 198.51.100.77, 203.0.113.45, user-01 (confidence High, 95/100; verdict: Unreviewed).

Key observations

Stage (ATT&CK tactic)	Severity	What was observed	Refs
Reconnaissance	MEDIUM	192.0.2.50 probed 40 distinct ports on 1 destination(s) in 39s. (+1 more reconnaissance finding)	F002, F003
Initial Access	HIGH	SQL injection pattern in 4 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. 1 returned HTTP 2xx - verify whether the payload had any effect. (+5 more initial access findings)	F001, F004, F005, F006...
Credential Access	HIGH	22 failed logins from 203.0.113.45 against 1 account(s) over 4m 12s. (+1 more credential access finding)	F007, F017
Execution	HIGH	Encoded PowerShell on dc01: powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -enc SQBFAFgAIAAoAE4AZQB3AC0ATwBiAGoAZQBjAHQAIABOAGUAdAAuAFc (+1 more execution finding)	F010, F011
Persistence	CRITICAL	Audit log cleared on dc01 (1 event(s)): The audit log was cleared (+2 more persistence findings)	F012, F013, F016
Exfiltration	HIGH	72.2 MB sent from 10.0.5.20 to external 198.51.100.77 over 29m 45s (6 flow(s)).	F015

Incident overview

Incident	Severity	Confidence	Window (UTC)	Verdict	Title
INC-001	CRITICAL	High (95)	2026-03-13 21:58 to 2026-03-13 23:52	Unreviewed	Multi-stage activity involving 198.51.100.77, 203.0.113.45, user-01
INC-002	HIGH	Low (30)	2026-03-14 03:10 to 2026-03-14 03:14	Unreviewed	Credential Access activity involving 198.51.100.23
INC-003	MEDIUM	Low (30)	2026-03-13 08:37 to 2026-03-13 13:33	Unreviewed	Initial Access activity involving 192.0.2.77, user-02
INC-004	MEDIUM	Low (30)	2026-03-13 14:20 to 2026-03-13 14:20	Unreviewed	Reconnaissance activity involving 192.0.2.50



2. Scope and evidence integrity

SHA-256 hashes identify the exact files analysed. Rows without a parseable timestamp are dropped, never guessed.

File	SHA-256	Rows read	Kept	Bad time	Bad IP
endpoint_events.json	8c2b69bee66f83481ef839fdc8eebe3fbb63047a5d07b169b243057056c56b19	6	6	0	0
firewall.csv	7917a8b1f71554018c5af0c19d6244215d1b07ea485d91b6e094d564c657d2fa	86	86	0	0
vpn_auth.csv	da24574c53e0bb9a2d0dec5b6f22bb1868af95b68a3149570293c75a1193fd4b	134	134	0	0
web_access.json	66e4df55ffefb9f517f3bccda1d44161b1384267df82450c69f7a8d844f46938	329	329	0	0

Field mapping detected per file

endpoint_events.json: timestamp <- @timestamp, src_ip <- source.ip, user <- user.name, event_type <- event.action, host <- host.name, message <- message, command <- process.command_line

firewall.csv: timestamp <- epoch, src_ip <- src, dst_ip <- dst, dst_port <- dport, event_type <- action, bytes_out <- bytes_sent

vpn_auth.csv: timestamp <- timestamp, src_ip <- client_ip, user <- username, event_type <- event, host <- hostname, message <- message

web_access.json: timestamp <- time, src_ip <- client_ip, host <- host, status_code <- status, url <- uri

Integrity and audit status

Evidence re-verified 2026-11-05 10:25:16 UTC: all stored files match their SHA-256.

Audit log: 11 entries, hash chain intact, head 3d552b9c581dbec791012c9cf77d1597e06a9967bd2389f487d0dfa68e9ed7c9.

3. Affected assets

Type	Entity	Incidents	Events
Account	user-01	INC-001	30
Account	user-02	INC-003	11
Host	dc01	INC-001	6
Internal IP	10.0.5.20	INC-001	12
Internal IP	10.0.2.21	INC-003	9
External IP	203.0.113.45	INC-001	91
External IP	192.0.2.50	INC-004	40
External IP	198.51.100.23	INC-002	13
External IP	198.51.100.77	INC-001	6
External IP	192.0.2.77	INC-003	1

4. Incident analysis

4.1 INC-001 - Multi-stage activity involving 198.51.100.77, 203.0.113.45, user-01

14 detection finding(s) from 4 log source(s) were correlated between 2026-03-13 21:58 and 23:52 UTC (1h 54m).

Observed kill-chain progression: Reconnaissance > Initial Access > Credential Access > Execution > Persistence > Exfiltration > IOC match.

Severity	CRITICAL	**Confidence**	High (95/100)
Window	2026-03-13 21:58:00 to 23:52:20 UTC	**Verdict**	Unreviewed
IP addresses	203.0.113.45, 10.0.5.20, 198.51.100.77	**Accounts**	user-01
Hosts	dc01	**ATT&CK**	T1048, T1059, T1078, T1110, T1136 / T1098 / T1070.001, T1190, T1595.002
Log sources	endpoint_events.json, firewall.csv, vpn_auth.csv, web_access.json	**Evidence**	103 events, 14 findings

Reconstructed timeline

Time (UTC)	Stage	Observation	Ref
2026-03-13 21:58:00	Reconnaissance	62 client-error responses (404) for 203.0.113.45 against web01 in 3m 03s.	F003
2026-03-13 22:03:10	Initial Access	SQL injection pattern in 4 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. 1 returned HTTP 2xx - verify whether the payload had any effect.	F004
2026-03-13 22:03:50	Initial Access	Cross-site scripting pattern in 1 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. No 2xx responses seen.	F005
2026-03-13 22:04:10	Initial Access	Path traversal pattern in 1 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. No 2xx responses seen.	F006
2026-03-13 22:15:00	Credential Access	22 failed logins from 203.0.113.45 against 1 account(s) over 4m 12s.	F007
2026-03-13 22:15:00	Initial Access	Account 'user-01' logged in from 203.0.113.45 after 22 failed attempts within 30 min.	F008
2026-03-13 22:20:11	Initial Access	'user-01' logged in from 203.0.113.45 at 22:20 UTC on 2026-03-13 (outside 07:00-19:00 UTC).	F009
2026-03-13 22:24:40	Execution	Discovery / enumeration on dc01: whoami /all	F010
2026-03-13 22:27:03	Execution	Encoded PowerShell on dc01: powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -enc SQBFAFgAIAAoAE4AZQB3AC0ATwBiAGoAZQBjAHQAIABOAGUAdAAuAFc	F011
2026-03-13 22:31:12	Persistence	Account created on dc01 (1 event(s)): A user account was created: svc_backup2	F012
2026-03-13 22:31:40	Persistence	Added to privileged group on dc01 (1 event(s)): svc_backup2 was added to the Administrators group	F013
2026-03-13 23:10:20	IOC match	IOC ipv4 '198.51.100.77' appears in 6 event(s) - note: sample.	F014
2026-03-13 23:10:20	Exfiltration	72.2 MB sent from 10.0.5.20 to external 198.51.100.77 over 29m 45s (6 flow(s)).	F015
2026-03-13 23:52:20	Persistence	Audit log cleared on dc01 (1 event(s)): The audit log was cleared	F016

Why this confidence score

Factor	Points
Baseline for any rule-based finding	+20
9 independent detection rule(s) fired	+30
Corroborated by 4 different log sources	+15
Activity spans 6 ATT&CK tactics (kill-chain progression)	+15
Evidence of success/impact (login after failures, persistence or data transfer)	+10
Matches an analyst-recorded IOC	+10

Heuristic score, not a probability. Treat it as a prompt for validation.

Supporting evidence (first 25 events)

Event	Time (UTC)	Type	Source IP	Account	Host	Detail
E000439	21:58:00	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/old/0 [404]
E000440	21:58:03	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000441	21:58:06	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000442	21:58:09	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/old/3 [404]
E000443	21:58:12	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]
E000444	21:58:15	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/phpmyadmin/ [404]
E000445	21:58:18	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/phpmyadmin/ [404]
E000446	21:58:21	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]
E000447	21:58:24	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000448	21:58:27	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000449	21:58:30	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]
E000450	21:58:33	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000451	21:58:36	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]
E000452	21:58:39	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/old/13 [404]
E000453	21:58:42	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/admin [404]
E000454	21:58:45	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000455	21:58:48	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/old/16 [404]
E000456	21:58:51	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/admin [404]
E000457	21:58:54	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000458	21:58:57	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/wp-login.php [404]
E000459	21:59:00	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000460	21:59:03	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/backup.zip [404]
E000461	21:59:06	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]
E000462	21:59:09	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/old/23 [404]
E000463	21:59:12	web_request	203.0.113.45	-	web01	/.git/config [404]

78 further events are listed in the evidence CSV export.

Response actions

Action	Owner	Done
Immediate containment		
Block the destination IP/domain and capture network evidence.		[ ]
Disable any account or group membership that was not change-approved.		[ ]
Isolate the host from the network (EDR containment) pending triage.		[ ]
Block or rate-limit the source IP at the firewall / WAF.		[ ]
Treat the account as potentially compromised: disable it and revoke active sessions/tokens.		[ ]
Block the source at the WAF and review responses (HTTP 200 on a payload warrants deeper review).		[ ]
Rate-limit or block the scanning IP.		[ ]
Investigation and scoping		
Scope the activity: search all other log sources for the same indicator.		[ ]
Identify what data was on the source host and assess breach-notification duties.		[ ]
Preserve the affected host's logs/disk image before cleanup (evidence).		[ ]
Collect the process tree, memory and the decoded payload for analysis.		[ ]
Hunt for the same command pattern on other hosts.		[ ]
Verify the login with the account owner or on-call roster.		[ ]
Review everything the account did after the successful login.		[ ]
Confirm no discovered path exposes sensitive content.		[ ]
Recovery and hardening		
Restore audit logging and forward logs off-host so they cannot be wiped locally.		[ ]
Enforce account lockout and MFA on the targeted service.		[ ]
Reset credentials and re-enrol MFA after the account is verified with its owner.		[ ]
Patch or harden the targeted application and review its database/app logs.		[ ]

4.2 INC-002 - Credential Access activity involving 198.51.100.23

1 detection finding(s) from 1 log source(s) were correlated between 2026-03-14 03:10 and 03:14 UTC (4m).

Observed kill-chain progression: Credential Access.

Severity	HIGH	**Confidence**	Low (30/100)
Window	2026-03-14 03:10:00 to 03:14:00 UTC	**Verdict**	Unreviewed
IP addresses	198.51.100.23	**Accounts**	-
Hosts	-	**ATT&CK**	T1110.003
Log sources	vpn_auth.csv	**Evidence**	13 events, 1 findings

Reconstructed timeline

Time (UTC)	Stage	Observation	Ref
2026-03-14 03:10:00	Credential Access	198.51.100.23 failed against 13 distinct accounts (13 attempts) over 4m 00s.	F017

Why this confidence score

Factor	Points
Baseline for any rule-based finding	+20
1 independent detection rule(s) fired	+10

Heuristic score, not a probability. Treat it as a prompt for validation.

Supporting evidence (first 25 events)

Event	Time (UTC)	Type	Source IP	Account	Host	Detail
E000543	03:10:00	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-01	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-01
E000544	03:10:20	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-02	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-02
E000545	03:10:40	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-03	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-03
E000546	03:11:00	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-04	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-04
E000547	03:11:20	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-05	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-05
E000548	03:11:40	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-06	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-06
E000549	03:12:00	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-07	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-07
E000550	03:12:20	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-08	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-08
E000551	03:12:40	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-09	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-09
E000552	03:13:00	login_failure	198.51.100.23	user-10	vpn-gw	Failed password for user-10
E000553	03:13:20	login_failure	198.51.100.23	root	vpn-gw	Failed password for root
E000554	03:13:40	login_failure	198.51.100.23	admin	vpn-gw	Failed password for admin
E000555	03:14:00	login_failure	198.51.100.23	backup	vpn-gw	Failed password for backup

Response actions

Action	Owner	Done
Immediate containment		
Block the source IP and review all accounts it targeted.		[ ]
Force password reset for any targeted account that later logged in successfully.		[ ]
Recovery and hardening		
Enable MFA and smart-lockout on the authentication endpoint.		[ ]

4.3 INC-003 - Initial Access activity involving 192.0.2.77, user-02

1 detection finding(s) from 1 log source(s) were correlated between 2026-03-13 08:37 and 13:33 UTC (4h 56m).

Observed kill-chain progression: Initial Access.

Severity	MEDIUM	**Confidence**	Low (30/100)
Window	2026-03-13 08:37:33 to 13:33:38 UTC	**Verdict**	Unreviewed
IP addresses	10.0.2.21, 192.0.2.77	**Accounts**	user-02
Hosts	-	**ATT&CK**	T1078
Log sources	vpn_auth.csv	**Evidence**	10 events, 1 findings

Reconstructed timeline

Time (UTC)	Stage	Observation	Ref
2026-03-13 08:37:33	Initial Access	Account 'user-02' authenticated from 2 IPs (10.0.2.21, 192.0.2.77) within 60 min.	F001

Why this confidence score

Factor	Points
Baseline for any rule-based finding	+20
1 independent detection rule(s) fired	+10

Heuristic score, not a probability. Treat it as a prompt for validation.

Supporting evidence (first 25 events)

Event	Time (UTC)	Type	Source IP	Account	Host	Detail
E000058	08:37:33	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000089	09:22:25	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000108	10:11:26	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000133	11:02:00	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000145	11:20:00	login_success	192.0.2.77	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO (mobile hotspot)
E000147	11:23:22	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000161	11:48:22	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000179	12:18:55	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000190	12:59:08	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO
E000211	13:33:38	login_success	10.0.2.21	user-02	vpn-gw	user-02 authenticated via SSO

Response actions

Action	Owner	Done
Immediate containment		
Revoke sessions and require re-authentication if not.		[ ]
Investigation and scoping		
Confirm with the user whether both locations are legitimate.		[ ]

4.4 INC-004 - Reconnaissance activity involving 192.0.2.50

1 detection finding(s) from 1 log source(s) were correlated between 2026-03-13 14:20 and 14:20 UTC (0m).

Observed kill-chain progression: Reconnaissance.

Severity	MEDIUM	**Confidence**	Low (30/100)
Window	2026-03-13 14:20:01 to 14:20:40 UTC	**Verdict**	Unreviewed
IP addresses	192.0.2.50	**Accounts**	-
Hosts	-	**ATT&CK**	T1046
Log sources	firewall.csv	**Evidence**	40 events, 1 findings

Reconstructed timeline

Time (UTC)	Stage	Observation	Ref
2026-03-13 14:20:01	Reconnaissance	192.0.2.50 probed 40 distinct ports on 1 destination(s) in 39s.	F002

Why this confidence score

Factor	Points
Baseline for any rule-based finding	+20
1 independent detection rule(s) fired	+10

Heuristic score, not a probability. Treat it as a prompt for validation.

Supporting evidence (first 25 events)

Event	Time (UTC)	Type	Source IP	Account	Host	Detail
E000236	14:20:01	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:23
E000237	14:20:02	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:46
E000238	14:20:03	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:69
E000239	14:20:04	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:92
E000240	14:20:05	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:115
E000241	14:20:06	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:138
E000242	14:20:07	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:161
E000243	14:20:08	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:184
E000244	14:20:09	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:207
E000245	14:20:10	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:230
E000246	14:20:11	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:253
E000247	14:20:12	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:276
E000248	14:20:13	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:299
E000249	14:20:14	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:322
E000250	14:20:15	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:345
E000251	14:20:16	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:368
E000252	14:20:17	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:391
E000253	14:20:18	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:414
E000254	14:20:19	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:437
E000255	14:20:20	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:460
E000256	14:20:21	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:483
E000257	14:20:22	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:506
E000258	14:20:23	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:529
E000259	14:20:24	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:552
E000260	14:20:25	firewall_block	192.0.2.50	-	-	to 10.0.1.5:575

15 further events are listed in the evidence CSV export.

Response actions

Action	Owner	Done
Immediate containment		
Block the scanning IP.		[ ]
Investigation and scoping		
Review which scanned services must be exposed at all.		[ ]

5. Indicators of compromise

Type	Value	Source	Note	Added (UTC)
ipv4	`198.51.100.77`	Sample Analyst	sample	2026-11-05 10:25:15

Candidate indicators suggested by incidents (not yet recorded)

- ipv4: `203.0.113.45` - External IP seen in correlated findings
- username: `user-01` - Account with successful login after failures
- ipv4: `198.51.100.23` - External IP seen in correlated findings
- ipv4: `192.0.2.77` - External IP seen in correlated findings
- ipv4: `192.0.2.50` - External IP seen in correlated findings

DRAFT

Appendix A. Findings register

ID	Start (UTC)	Rule and observation	Severity	ATT&CK	Events	Incident
F001	2026-03-13 08:37:33	**Account used from multiple IPs** Account 'user-02' authenticated from 2 IPs (10.0.2.21, 192.0.2.77) within 60 min.	MEDIUM	T1078	10	INC-003
F002	2026-03-13 14:20:01	**Port scan** 192.0.2.50 probed 40 distinct ports on 1 destination(s) in 39s.	MEDIUM	T1046	40	INC-004
F003	2026-03-13 21:58:00	**Web scanning / forced browsing** 62 client-error responses (404) for 203.0.113.45 against web01 in 3m 03s.	MEDIUM	T1595.002	62	INC-001
F004	2026-03-13 22:03:10	**Web attack payload in request** SQL injection pattern in 4 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. 1 returned HTTP 2xx - verify whether the payload had any eff...	HIGH	T1190	4	INC-001
F005	2026-03-13 22:03:50	**Web attack payload in request** Cross-site scripting pattern in 1 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. No 2xx responses seen.	HIGH	T1190	1	INC-001
F006	2026-03-13 22:04:10	**Web attack payload in request** Path traversal pattern in 1 request(s) from 203.0.113.45. No 2xx responses seen.	HIGH	T1190	1	INC-001
F007	2026-03-13 22:15:00	**Repeated failed logins (brute force)** 22 failed logins from 203.0.113.45 against 1 account(s) over 4m 12s.	HIGH	T1110	22	INC-001
F008	2026-03-13 22:15:00	**Successful login after failures** Account 'user-01' logged in from 203.0.113.45 after 22 failed attempts within 30 min.	HIGH	T1078	23	INC-001
F009	2026-03-13 22:20:11	**Off-hours login** 'user-01' logged in from 203.0.113.45 at 22:20 UTC on 2026-03-13 (outside 07:00-19:00 UTC).	LOW	T1078	1	INC-001
F010	2026-03-13 22:24:40	**Suspicious command line** Discovery / enumeration on dc01: whoami /all	MEDIUM	T1059	2	INC-001
F011	2026-03-13 22:27:03	**Suspicious command line** Encoded PowerShell on dc01: powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -enc SQBFAFgAIAAoAE4AZQB3AC0ATwBiAGoAZQBjAHQAIABOAGUAdAAuAFc	HIGH	T1059	1	INC-001
F012	2026-03-13 22:31:12	**Sensitive account / audit activity** Account created on dc01 (1 event(s)): A user account was created: svc_backup2	HIGH	T1136 / T1098 / T1070.001	1	INC-001
F013	2026-03-13 22:31:40	**Sensitive account / audit activity** Added to privileged group on dc01 (1 event(s)): svc_backup2 was added to the Administrators group	HIGH	T1136 / T1098 / T1070.001	1	INC-001
F014	2026-03-13 23:10:20	**Event matches recorded IOC** IOC ipv4 '198.51.100.77' appears in 6 event(s) - note: sample.	HIGH	n/a	6	INC-001
F015	2026-03-13 23:10:20	**Large outbound transfer** 72.2 MB sent from 10.0.5.20 to external 198.51.100.77 over 29m 45s (6 flow(s)).	HIGH	T1048	6	INC-001
F016	2026-03-13 23:52:20	**Sensitive account / audit activity** Audit log cleared on dc01 (1 event(s)): The audit log was cleared	CRITICAL	T1136 / T1098 / T1070.001	1	INC-001
F017	2026-03-14 03:10:00	**Password spraying** 198.51.100.23 failed against 13 distinct accounts (13 attempts) over 4m 00s.	HIGH	T1110.003	13	INC-002

Appendix B. MITRE ATT&CK techniques observed

Technique	Name	Stage	Findings
T1046	Network Service Discovery	Reconnaissance	1
T1048	Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol	Exfiltration	1
T1059	Command and Scripting Interpreter	Execution	2

Technique	Name	Stage	Findings
T1070.001	Clear Windows Event Logs	Persistence	3
T1078	Valid Accounts	Initial Access	3
T1098	Account Manipulation	Persistence	3
T1110	Brute Force	Credential Access	1
T1110.003	Password Spraying	Credential Access	1
T1136	Create Account	Persistence	3
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Initial Access	3
T1595.002	Vulnerability Scanning	Reconnaissance	1

Appendix C. Methodology, definitions and limitations

- Pipeline: import (CSV, JSON/NDJSON, text logs, Windows Event XML and Sysmon, Zeek, AWS CloudTrail, ZIP/gzip bundles) > normalise timestamps to UTC, IP addresses, usernames and event types > rule-based detection > correlation of findings that share an IP, account or host within a configurable time gap > transparent scoring.
- TraceForge analyses only the files supplied. It is not a live SIEM and does not claim to detect attacks that are absent from the evidence or that no enabled rule covers.
- Timestamps without a timezone are interpreted as UTC. Rows without a parseable timestamp are dropped and counted, never guessed. No GeoIP or threat-intelligence feeds are queried; IOC matching uses only indicators recorded by the analyst.
- Severity and confidence are heuristics. A finding can be a false positive (for example a user on a mobile hotspot); the analyst verdict recorded in this report takes precedence.
- Built-in rules enabled: 17 of 17. Rules that produced findings in this run: Account used from multiple IPs, Event matches recorded IOC, Large outbound transfer, Off-hours login, Password spraying, Port scan, Repeated failed logins (brute force), Sensitive account / audit activity, Successful login after failures, Suspicious command line, Web attack payload in request, Web scanning / forced browsing.

Severity (indicative meaning)

Level	Meaning
Critical	Activity consistent with an active, multi-stage compromise. Raised automatically when an incident spans three or more ATT&CK tactics and contains at least one High finding. Respond immediately.
High	Likely malicious activity that should be investigated promptly.
Medium	Suspicious activity that needs validation; may be benign.
Low / Info	Weak signal or context. Usually benign on its own.

Confidence

A heuristic score from 5 to 95 built from the factors listed under each incident: High is 70 or more, Medium 40 to 69, Low below 40. It reflects how much independent evidence supports the finding, not the probability that it is malicious.

Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by	Sample Analyst		
Reviewed by			
Approved by			